

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 2
♥ J 10 9
♦ A J 7 2
♣ Q 10 9 8

♠ K 6 5 3

♥ A 7 4

♦ Q 8 3

♣ A K 4



♠ J 10 9 7

♥ Q 6 5 2

♦ 10 6 4

♣ 7 5

♠ A Q 4

♥ K 8 3

♦ K 9 5

♣ J 6 3 2

*West**North**East**South*

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

Lead: ♠J

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♠J, won by dummy's ♠Q. The ♦5 is now played from dummy. What do you play?

Play the ♦2. Considering that North opened 1NT, he must have the ♦Q for this play to make sense.

So if you put on your ♦A, North will have TWO ♦ winners established. If instead you play low, then North cannot get a second ♦ trick and will have to look elsewhere for his ninth trick. As you can see, he is not going to be able to find it.

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A 6
 ♥ K 9 3
 ♦ A Q J 7 4
 ♣ K Q 7

♠ 9 7 5 3

♥ Q

♦ K 10 5 2

♣ 8 6 5 4

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W		E
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♠ K Q J 8 2

♥ A 8 7 6 2

♦ 8

♣ A 2

♠ 10 4

♥ J 10 5 4

♦ 9 6 3

♣ J 10 9 3

West	North	East	South
		1 ♠	Pass
3 ♦	Pass	3 ♥	Pass
3NT	Pass	4 ♥	Pass
4NT	Pass	5 ♥	Pass
6 ♥			
All Pass			
6 ♥ by East			
Lead: ♣J			

You are South. The bidding has been as shown.

Your lead of the ♣J was won by East with the ♣A. East then played the ♥2 and you must decide whether to split your honors.

Play the ♥4, do not split your Honors.

East's bidding showed at least 5 ♥s, so assuming he holds both the ♥A Q, it would be silly for him to finesse the ♥9 on the first trump play.

As it turns out, when you play low East calls for dummy's ♥K, North's ♥Q falls and you now have 2 trump tricks. If you had played the ♥10 you would have tossed away the setting trick.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10 6 4

♥ K

♦ 7 6 4 2

♣ K Q 7 5

♠ K 7

♥ J 8 6 3 2

♦ K 5 3

♣ 10 4 2



♠ Q 9 8 3 2

♥ Q 4

♦ 10 9 8

♣ A 9 3

♠ A 5

♥ A 10 9 7 5

♦ A Q J

♣ J 8 6

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by South

Lead: ♣K

1♥

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♣K, and you played the ♣9 to encourage him. He continued with the ♣Q, then a small card to your ♣A. You then exit with the ♦10, taken by dummy's ♦K.

Declarer then calls for the ♥J. Do you cover with your ♥Q or not?

Play the ♥4.

North has 5 ♥s and South must have at least 5. The reason you cover an Honor is that you hope to establish a lower card in either your hand or partner's hand. But your partner has one ♥ at the most so there is no hope of establishment.

Now that you have looked at the hands aren't you glad you didn't cover?

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q 9 7 4 2

♥ 9 4

♦ A K Q J

♣ A K

♠ K J 3

♥ J 10 8 5

♦ 10 6

♣ 9 7 6 4



♠ A 10 5

♥ Q 6 3

♦ 8 7 4 2

♣ J 8 5

♠ 8 6

♥ A K 7 2

♦ 9 5 3

♣ Q 10 3 2

West

1 ♠

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by West

Lead: ♥ J

North

Pass

East

2 ♠

South

Pass

You are North. The bidding has been as shown.

You lead the ♥ J, covered by dummy's ♥ Q and won by South's ♥ K. South wins the ♥ A at the second trick and continues with a small ♥ ruffed by West.

West then plays the ♠ 4 from his hand. Do you play low? or play the ♠ J to force dummy's ♠ A?

Play the ♠ 3.

If West decides to finesse the ♠ 10 then you will still win the one ♠ trick which you are entitled to win.

However, with West holding the ♠ Q it would be very logical for him to go up with the ♠ A then lead back toward his ♠ Q, playing South for the ♠ K. If he plays this way you will get two tricks and defeat the contract.

Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q J 6 2

♥ 6 5 3

♦ 9 7 2

♣ 5 4 3

♠ A 10 8

♥ K Q 4

♦ A K 10

♣ A 9 8 2



♠ 9 5 3

♥ 9 8 7 2

♦ 8 6 5 3

♣ K 6

♠ K 7 4

♥ A J 10

♦ Q J 4

♣ Q J 10 7

West

North

East

South

2NT

Pass

6NT

All Pass

6NT by North

Lead: ♥9

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♥9, taken by dummy's ♥10. The ♠4 is then played from dummy. Do you play low? or split your honors?

Play the ♠J (or ♠Q).

You should always make a point count check as soon as you see dummy. North's 2NT promises 20 or 21 points, South has 14 and you have 3; total = 37 or 38. Therefore East must have either 2 or 3 points. He cannot have two Jacks because you can see all four of them. Likewise he cannot have a Queen because you can see three of them and his ♥ lead (top of nothing) denied that Queen.

It follows that East **MUST** have a King, and it must be ♣s or ♦s since he has denied any ♥ Honor.

Since East will definitely win his King, you need to take one trick yourself, and the best way to do that is to split your Honors to establish one ♠ winner.

North has no defense to this, but if you had played low he would have played the ♠10 and made the slam.